

Default Question Block

Welcome to the "Mapping Digital Research Competencies Pedagogies Survey"

Thank you for your interest in participating in this research study! The survey will take approximately 10–15 minutes of your time.

About us

The survey is being run by the University of Warwick as part of the project "Mapping and evaluating dRTP's contributions to computing skills pedagogies in HE", funded by [UKRI's Network+ DisCouRSE](#)'s Flexible Fund. The lead researchers are Dr [Carlos Cámara-Menoyo](#) and Dr [Timothy Monteath](#).

About our research

By participating in the survey, you will help us to better understand the role played by people, methodologies and infrastructure in the provision of digital research competencies (DRP) across higher-education institutions. The findings will offer evidence-based recommendations for policymakers, dRTPs and educators to enhance DRP curricula across HE, guiding

when and how to involve specialist trainers and applying appropriate pedagogical approaches and tools for different contexts.

To do so, we will be asking you **two sets of questions**: a first one **about you** (role, career stage...) and then **about any training you've been involved with** (context, your role, contents, and technologies involved). You will be able to write about as many trainings as you want to. **We do not collect identifiable data as part of this study.**

Audience

The survey is for people, based in the UK, who self-identify as a digital Research Technical Professional in HE. We use "dRTP" as an inclusive and open term to refer to the wide range of professionals whose work supports, enables, or advances research through digital tools, data, infrastructure, or technical expertise. For more information, refer to <https://discourse-network.github.io/who>

Data usage

To maximise the value of your contributions, we will make the resulting dataset open access. We ask that you please avoid putting information that could identify you (or other individuals) in the free text fields. In making this data set open access, we also reserve the

right to edit or redact any answers that we believe may breach your or others' anonymity

By completing the survey, we take it that you are consenting to the data you provide being included in the study.

- ▶ **Data withdrawal**
- ▶ **Data processing**
- ▶ **Complaints**

Participation is entirely voluntary, and we are very grateful for your help if you decide to proceed.

Are you happy to proceed with the survey?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Have you ever worked (now or in the past) as a digital Research Technical Professional in UK higher education?

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☐ Yes

☐ No

People - About you

People - About you

First, we'd like to ask a few contextual questions about you.

What is your current role/job title?

Who is your employer? (if you do not want to be

specific, you can provide other descriptor e.g. Russell Group, Post 92, independent research organisation etc)

How many years have you worked as a dRTP (in this role or similar one) in HE?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ less than a year
- ☐ 1-5 years
- ☐ 5-9 years
- ☐ 10 or more years

Have you worked in a similar technical role outside HE before?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

How many years have you worked in a similar technical role outside of HE?

- ☐ Less than a year
- ☐ 1-5 years
- ☐ 5-9 years
- ☐ 10 or more years

What is your current contract type?

- ☐ Permanent
- ☐ Fixed-term
- ☐ Open ended
- ☐ Contractor/consultant
- ☐ Other

Is your role part-time or full-time?

- ☐ Full-time: this is my only job
- ☐ Part-time: this is my only paid job
- ☐ Part-time: I combine this job with studying
- ☐ Part-time: I combine this job with another dRTP job
- ☐ Part-time: I combine this job with other type of employment

What's the highest degree you've earned?

- ☐ PhD Degree
- ☐ Master's degree
- ☐ Bachelor's degree
- ☐ None of the above

How would you describe your disciplinary expertise?
(e.g. computer science, sociology, physics,
interdisciplinary...)

Have you received training or education in teaching?

- ☐ Yes, I have received significant training on teaching or pedagogy (e.g. Degree, PGCert, etc.)
- ☐ Yes, I have received some training on teaching or pedagogy (e.g. dedicated course)
- ☐ Yes, I have received training on how to teach technical skills (e.g. carpentries)
- ☐ No, I have not received any training on teaching or pedagogy

Can you briefly describe the training received?

Teaching involvement

Have you ever (now or in the past) been involved in **delivering any form of training or teaching about technical digital competencies** (e.g. coding, computational thinking, technical tools, infrastructure, methods...)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

Training

Think about a particular training on digital technical competencies that you were involved with and are particularly fond of or worked well.

All the questions in this section will be referring to this specific training. You will have an option later to repeat

this as many times as you want for other trainings.

Name of the training you will be referring to in this section

(it can be the official name of the training or a different, descriptive one)

Here, we want to know about the context of "\${q://QID28/ChoiceTextEntryValue}"

Who was its **audience**? (check all that apply)

- ☐ Undergraduate students
- ☐ taught masters students
- ☐ PhD students
- ☐ Research staff
- ☐ Technical staff
- ☐ Others outside of HE
- ☐ Other

What **type of training** was?

- ☐ Part of a degree's curricula: core
- ☐ Part of a degree's curricula: optional
- ☐ Formal training (e.g. course or workshop must be taken before access HPC services)
- ☐ Informal training (e.g. course or workshop can be taken by anyone wanting to learn about HPC services)

Was any form of certificate/Accreditation awarded at completion?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

What was its **delivery mode**?

- ☐ Online
- ☐ In person
- ☐ Hybrid

What was its **format mode**?

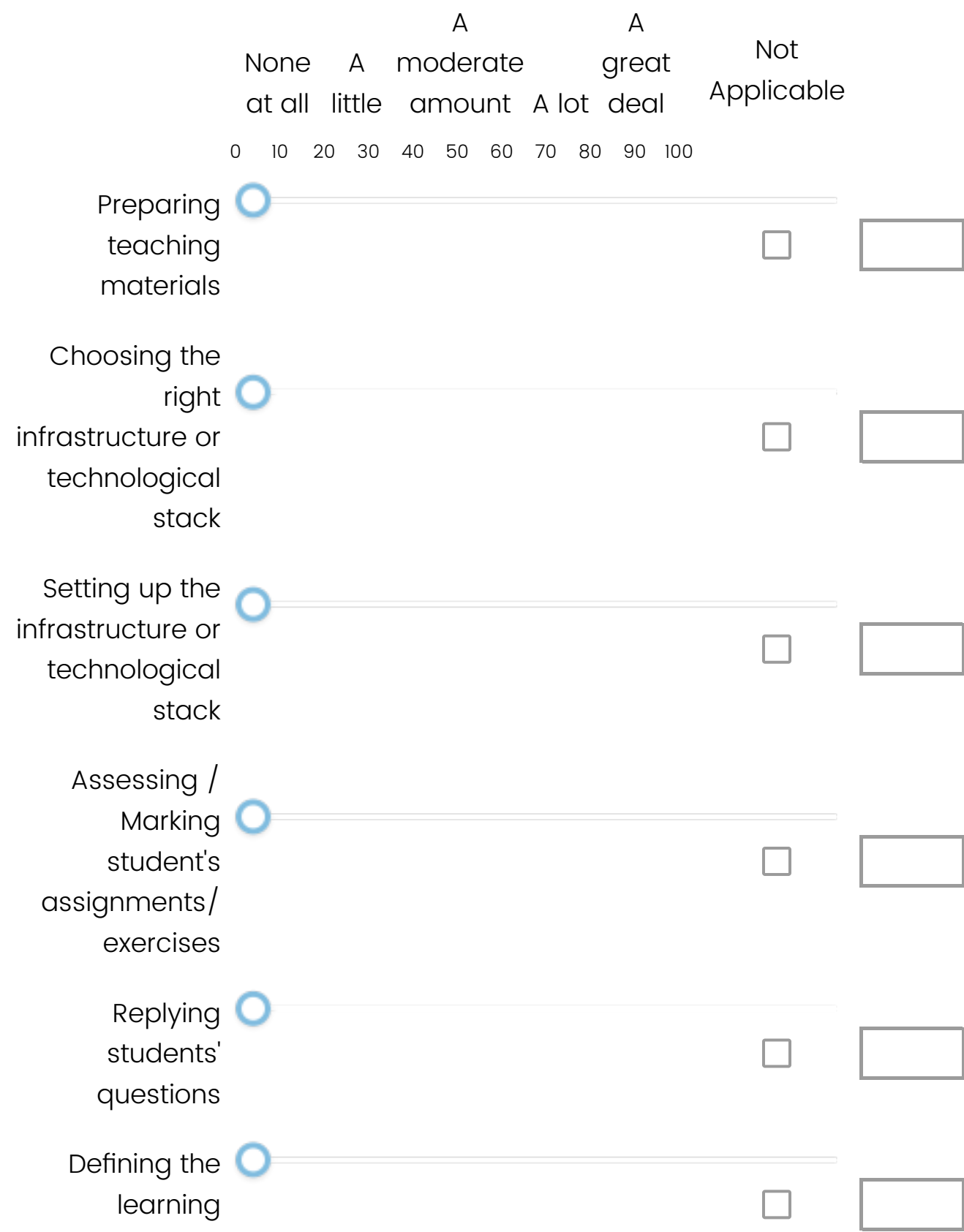
	I was involved	Other staff was involved	Not available
Workshop	☐	☐	☐
Lecture	☐	☐	☐
Lab	☐	☐	☐
Q&A	☐	☐	☐
Other 	☐	☐	☐

Here, we want to know about your involvement in "\${q://QID28/ChoiceTextEntryValue}"

What **role** did you play in "\${q://QID28/ChoiceTextEntryValue}"?

- ☐ Educator (lead) (i.e. teaching classes or workshops)
- ☐ Educator (support) (i.e. providing support to students during a class or course)
- ☐ Technical support (i.e. providing support through office hours, troubleshooting...)
- ☐ Back office support (i.e. managing infrastructure)
- ☐ Developing resources (i.e. writing software, technical documentation...)

Roughly, what **percentage of the total time you spent** in preparing "\$ {q://QID28/ChoiceTextEntryValue}" did you spend in the following tasks?



outcomes

How important these factors were when choosing the technology stack for your course?

	Not at all important	Slightly important	Moderately important	Very important	Extremely important
Using the newest technology available	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using what that industry demands	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Having a licence provided by my employer	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology that is reasonably priced	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology that is Free/Libre OpenSource	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology that is aligned with the course's content	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology that enables me to deliver the teaching as I think is best	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology that students can replicate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Using a technology					

that does not
require set up

☐☐☐☐☐

Using a technology
that doesn't have
platform lock-in

☐☐☐☐☐

**Here, we want to know about the
contents in "\${q://QID28/
ChoiceTextEntryValue}"**

What was the type of Digital Research Competency
that was taught in this training?

- ☐ a technology, programming language or software
- ☐ a platform or service (Azure, ChatGTP, AWS, ...)
- ☐ a workflow to do certain tasks
- ☐ a concept
- ☐ a technique or method
- ☐ a hardware/device
- ☐ other

If you taught a specific technology, platform or service, please write its name or describe it below

Which of these competencies were taught in "\$ {q:// QID28/ChoiceTextEntryValue}"? (check all that apply)

Information and data technologies

- ☐ **Data Science:** Application of analytical, statistical or machine learning techniques to extract insight and value from complex or large datasets (big data)
- ☐ **Data Management:** Understanding and implementation of practices for data management, quality, accessibility, stewardship and compliance across data lifecycle

Software engineering and development

- ☐ **Web & mobile development:** Design and development of responsive, secure, and user-centric applications across web and mobile platforms
- ☐ **Software engineering methodologies & tools:** Application of structured approaches, theory and supporting tools to plan, develop, test, and maintain high-quality software systems efficiently
- ☐ **Software/computer science concepts & theory:** Foundational knowledge of computational principles and algorithms that inform software design, development and performance
- ☐ **User Interface/User Experience (UI/UX) design:** Creating intuitive, inclusive, and engaging digital experiences through thoughtful design and user-centered practices

ICT infrastructures

- ☐ **HPC infrastructure:** Knowledge of high-performance computing systems and practices that support intensive computational research and large-scale simulations
- ☐ **Web infrastructure:** Design, deployment, and maintenance of the technologies that support robust, scalable, and secure online platforms and services
- ☐ **Cloud infrastructure:** Expertise in leveraging cloud platforms to enable flexible, scalable, and cost-effective computing, storage, and data services

data services

- ☐ **General systems infrastructure:** Broad understanding of digital infrastructure – including hardware, networks, and system integration that supports everyday operations and research

Professional skills

- ☐ **Personal skills:** Self-management capabilities such as initiative, adaptability, resilience, time management, and a commitment to continuous learning.
- ☐ **Interpersonal skills:** Ability to build rapport, demonstrate empathy, navigate social dynamics, and communicate effectively in diverse professional settings
- ☐ **Teamwork and collaboration:** Working constructively and inclusively with others to achieve shared goals, contribute to group problem-solving, and foster a positive team culture

Leadership & management

- ☐ **People & team management:** Guiding and supporting individuals and teams to achieve their potential, with attention to wellbeing, performance, and professional growth
- ☐ **Leadership:** Setting direction, inspiring others, and making strategic decisions that align people and projects with broader institutional or organisational goals
- ☐ **Project management:** Planning, coordinating, and delivering projects effectively within defined scope, time, and resource constraints, while managing risk and quality

Domain expertise & research

- ☐ **Domain knowledge:** Deep understanding of the concepts, challenges, and methodologies specific to a particular scientific field
- ☐ **Research skills:** Conducting rigorous inquiry, including problem formulation, experimental design, critical analysis, and dissemination of findings

Communication

- ☐ **Verbal & written communication:** Articulating complex ideas clearly and effectively through a range of formats and for varied

audiences

- ☐ **Community & outreach:** Engaging with wider communities through knowledge sharing, collaboration, and public engagement to increase the visibility and impact of work
- ☐ **Training:** Designing and delivering effective learning experiences that build skills, transfer knowledge, and support capacity and capability development across audiences

**Here, we want to know about how
"\$ {q://QID28/
ChoiceTextEntryValue}" was
taught**

How many **days** did the training last? (write the number only)

How many **hours** (in total) did the training last? (write the number only)

Was there any work or study expected outside class?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Was there any formal assessment involved?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Did your training require any of these options? (check all that apply)

- ☐ Using a local environment (student's machines)
- ☐ Using a local environment (university equipment)
- ☐ Using a cloud environment
- ☐ Using on premises HPC
- ☐ Accessing an HPC remotely
- ☐ Subscription/licence to a service or software

Did you use any form of genAI to prepare this training?

- ☐ No, genAI was not available when I prepared this training
- ☐ No, I do not want to use genAI
- ☐ Yes, to design the course
- ☐ Yes, to help me identifying the main learning outcomes of the course
- ☐ Yes, to help me identifying key references, authors, methods...
- ☐ Yes, for other uses
- ☐ I do not want to answer

How did you use genAI?

Why did you decide not to use genAI to prepare this training?

- ☐ Because there's no genAI good enough for this
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about its reliability
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about sustainability
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about extractivism
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about academic integrity
- ☐ Other

How did your students engage with AI?

- ☐ Students were expected to use AI
- ☐ Students were encouraged to use AI
- ☐ Students were neither encouraged or discouraged to use AI
- ☐ Students were asked not to use AI
- ☐ This training was before AI's emergence

Why did you decide to ask students not to use genAI?

- ☐ Because that would prevent them from learning
- ☐ Because I do not know how to evaluate what's the student's contribution
- ☐ Because there's no genAI good enough for this
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about its reliability
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about sustainability
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about extractivism
- ☐ Because I'm concerned about academic integrity

Would you like to answer this section again, for a different training?

- ☐ Yes, let me answer again for another section.
- ☐ No. Take me to the next page of the survey (there are just 2 pages left!)

Future

Future challenges

Considering your previous answers, we want you to think about what are the future challenges in training digital research competencies in general (not necessarily related to any training in particular)

How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements?

	Strongly disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Strongly agree
Thinking about the infrastructure is as important as thinking about the contents of the training	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The use of AI will make teaching better	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The use of AI will make students to learn better	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The use of AI poses important challenges to teaching	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is important that universities provide students with licences for every technology they teach	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Only Free/Libre OpenSource solutions should be used	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

According to you, what do you think are going to be the

main challenges in training/teaching digital Research Competencies in the near future?

Intersectionality

Intersectionality (optional)

If you are comfortable answering a few questions about your identity, please do so here (otherwise, please select 'I prefer not to answer' or just click through to the next page)

Why are we asking this?

It is well-known that dRTPs are professions that skewed towards hegemonic demographics, which may bias results of this survey. Knowing about these details will help us to acknowledge that diversity (or lack of thereof) and how this might impact in results.

Please indicate which age bracket you fall into:

- ☐ Under 20
- ☐ 20-25
- ☐ 26-29
- ☐ 30-39
- ☐ 40-49
- ☐ 50-59
- ☐ 60 and over
- ☐ I prefer not to answer

Are you a person with a disability?

This may include a physical or mental impairment or medical condition that substantially limits life activity, or a history of such an impairment or medical condition.

- ☐ Yes, I have a physical disability, or have a history/record of having one
- ☐ Yes, I have a mental disability or neurodiversity, or have a history/record of having one
- ☐ Yes, I have both a mental and physical disability, or have a history/record of having them
- ☐ No, I do not have a disability, or a history/record of having one
- ☐ I prefer not to answer

What best describes your ethnic origin?

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black/ African/ Caribbean
- ☐ Asian (Indian, Pakistani, Bangladeshi, Chinese, any other Asian background)
- ☐ Mixed two or more ethnic groups
- ☐ Other (Arab or any others)
- ☐ Prefer not to say

What best describes your gender identity?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non binary
- ☐ Prefer to self describe
- ☐ I prefer not to answer

Do you identify as lesbian, gay, bisexual, pansexual, or asexual?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Other
- ☐ I prefer not to answer

Do you identify as transgender?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I prefer not to answer